

New York University
Tisch School of the Arts
Course Syllabus
4 Credits
Interactive Media Arts

*****PLEASE NOTE*****

This is a living document. Please check back here
for changes.

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GA Student Hours:

☐ Share GA OH Above

(Shoot emails if none of these times work for you and we could schedule accordingly)

Term: Fall 2026

Time: Mon 9-12

Spotify Playlist:

Shared Class Resources:

Shop Resources: <https://shop.itp.io>

Anonymous Feedback Form:

COURSE DESCRIPTION

This class is for students interested in making, displaying, and installing art for interactive media art exhibitions. This class will prepare you to apply for and develop work for open calls and everything else that happens after you are selected. The class will have an opportunity to exhibit a group show in a real NYC gallery towards the end of the semester. The students will collaborate to title, describe, and document the works in the show. They will also have an opportunity to do a public talk back about their work, organize a reception, and add a piece to their portfolio.

STUDENT HOURS/OPEN OFFICE HOURS

Office (student) hours: You all enter this classroom with different sets of skills. In virtue of this fact, I open my office to you as an extension of the classroom. I am available for you during that time and if you can't make it to the scheduled times, you are welcome to make an appointment with me at any time. There's no incorrect way to approach office hours, and they can be as formal or informal as you would like.

In this class, we will not shy away from difficult conversations and work closely together to cultivate a space of openness and mutual support.

I welcome you to contact me outside of class and office hours. You may email me, call me, or schedule an appointment through the link above. (statement adapted from [Syllabus as Manifesto](#))

COURSE OBJECTIVES

By the end of the course, students should be able to:

- Articulate and critically discuss different approaches to exhibition-making through readings, examples, and class discussions.
- Develop an Open Call exhibition.
- Identify and discuss exhibitions and other cultural forms through close observation
- Develop a media artwork from initial concept to public exhibition.
- Make informed decisions about the spatial, technical, interpretive, and experiential presentation of their work.
- Develop the practical materials necessary to exhibit a media artwork, including an installation plan and maintenance documentation.
- Participate collaboratively in the planning, production, installation, maintenance, documentation, and deinstallation of a group exhibition.
- Document and communicate an exhibited project for professional contexts, including an artist website, biography, and external open-call submission.
- Submit to Open Calls with their own artistic materials

Learning Modalities

To achieve these learning outcomes, you will:

- Read and annotate texts and other assigned course materials before class.
- Participate in class. Include: lectures, reading discussions, workshops, critiques, guest-speaker sessions, field trips, and group exhibition-planning activities.
- Give **1 Media Object Presentation** that brings an outside example into conversation with one of the course themes.
- Develop an individual artwork throughout the semester.
- Submit your work to the class open call and participate in the curatorial and production processes through which the exhibition takes shape.
- Develop **1 installation plan** and **1 maintenance document** for your work.
- Install, maintain, document, and deinstall your work.
- Give **1 final presentation** on your experience of exhibiting the work and reflect on what you learned through the process.
- Translate the completed project into professional materials and submit the work to an external open call.

This is an active, discussion- and production-based course. A substantial portion of class time will be used for collaborative workshops and exhibition production. Students are expected to arrive prepared to contribute to both their individual work and the collective exhibition.

EQUIPMENT

You will need a modern laptop (4 years old or younger is a good rule of thumb). Limited numbers are available for checkout from the department. Commercial software required in the course will be made available on the laptops available for checkout. Other required software is freely available.

I would also advise you download NYU's free Adobe license as well:

<https://www.nyu.edu/life/information-technology/computing-support/software/software/adobe.html>

COURSE MATERIALS

Students will be responsible for acquiring their project materials. Costs vary depending on the material and scale chosen. You should budget \$30 to \$50 at a minimum. There are also always free, but inconsistent materials on the ITP/IMA junk shelves. You will need graph paper, pens/pencils, and erasers.

GRADING AND ATTENDANCE

Grades for the course will follow the standard A through F letter grading system and will be determined by the following breakdown:

30% Participation

30% Assignments

40% Projects/Final Production

At most 2 absences will not affect your grade. Any more than 2 absences will result in a lowering of your final grade by one grade for each absence. For example, 3 absences will result in your highest possible grade being a B instead of an A. 3 late arrivals (more than 5 minutes after start time) will count for 1 absence.

While there is no distinction in this course between excused and unexcused absences, you may inquire with me about makeup work if you have more than 3 absences.

Being more than 10 minutes late to class will be considered $\frac{1}{3}$ of an absence.

PARTICIPATION

All of us in the class - you, me, your peers - have a responsibility to create an environment in which we can all learn from each other. I expect everyone to participate

in class so that we can all benefit from the insights and experiences that each person brings. You are encouraged to let me know what I can do to maximize your learning potential, participation and access to this course. I want to make the course material accessible and we want you to succeed as a student. If you need to present what you have learned in an alternative format, please see me to discuss this option. (statement adapted from [Cue Syllabus Guide](#) and [Shannon Madden and Tara Wood's Guide](#))

PHONE, TABLET, LAPTOP, AND OTHER ELECTRONICS USE

Laptops and mobile devices such as tablets are useful tools for learning and interaction within this class. However, they can create distractions that take away from a student's ability to actively participate. The structure of the class is dependent on each student's engagement. So please be mindful of the ways in which these devices can be a distraction and put the effort in to avoid them during class time.

TEACHING STYLE

Classes will be a mixture of lecture, discussion, hands-on tutorials, homework review, presentations, and group work. You will need to come to class prepared with a laptop and any other supplies specified for that class.

COURSE SCHEDULE

The course will be 1 time per week for 3 hours for a total of 14 weeks.

ASSIGNMENTS

There will be regular assignments that are relevant to the class material. These assignments must be documented (written description, photos, screenshots, screen recording, code, and video all qualify based on the assignment) on the class website. Each assignment is due by class time one week after they are assigned unless stated otherwise.

It is expected that you will spend 6 to 8 hours a week on the class outside of class itself. This will include reviewing material, reading, watching video, completing assignments and so on. Please budget your time accordingly.

Each assignment will be marked as complete (full credit), partially complete (half credit), or incomplete (no credit). To be complete, an assignment should meet the criteria specified in the syllabus including documentation. If significant portions are simply not attempted or the assignment is turned in late (up to 1 week) then it may be marked partially complete. If it is more than a week late, not turned in, or an attempt isn't made to meet the criteria specified it will be marked incomplete.

Responses to reading and other written assignments are also due in class one week after they are assigned and must also be submitted via the class website. Written assignments are expected to be 200 to 500 words in length unless otherwise specified. Grading will follow the same guidelines as above; on time and meeting the criteria specified will be marked as complete. Late (up to 1 week) or partially completed work will be given half credit. Work that is more than a week late, not turned in, or fails to meet the criteria specified will be given no credit.

ASSIGNMENT EXTENSIONS

An assignment extension will be granted upon request if the request of extension is at least 24 hours before the deadline. If you request an extension, your grade will not be affected. However, if you do not request an extension, the grading rules above apply.

READING PRESENTATION/DISCUSSION LEADER (20 MINS)

All students will sign up to present one reading over the semester that fits the theme of that day (~10 mins). After presenting, you will lead the class in a discussion of the reading (~10 mins). One to two students will be assigned for each class this semester, so you may want to coordinate your presentations and discussion questions with each other (or not). The topics and dates can be found in the syllabus.

MEDIA OBJECT PRESENTATION/DISCUSSION LEADER (15 MINS)

All students will sign up to present on a media object, event, exhibition, or phenomenon related to the readings for that day—either something referenced (but not developed) in the reading, or an outside object/event/phenomenon that speaks to its themes. One to two students will be assigned for each class this semester, so you may want to coordinate your presentations and discussion questions with each other (or not).

ASSIGNMENTS: JOURNAL ENTRIES and READING RESPONSES

Journal Entries:

All students will design, draw, describe, animate, etc a machine in reaction to each presentation. These designs will be presented in the next class for 5-10min

Reading Responses:

Course materials on BrightSpace consist of 5-30 pages of readings per week and are available via BrightSpace on Perusall. Unless otherwise instructed, you are expected to prepare for each class by reading all specified materials prior to class and annotating

the readings on Perusall, adding at least **2** annotations **on each material** listed in the readings and/or responding to classmates' annotations.

Consider the following when creating your annotations:

- Annotated content: your annotations should highlight or clarify key ideas. Therefore, be thoughtful about what parts you are annotating – don't just randomly choose parts of the text to annotate.
- Level of engagement: your annotations should add to the conversation by including questions, examples, connections, or elaboration/explanation, and demonstrate reflection and analysis of the text.

STATEMENT OF ACADEMIC INTEGRITY

Collaboration is highly valued and often necessary to produce great work. There are unacceptable forms of collaboration like cheating and plagiarism that have consequences. The act of plagiarism can be done intentionally and unintentionally. It is both the students' and instructor's responsibility to stay aware of the boundaries between collaboration and plagiarism within the classroom environment and the institution at large. Additional guidance can be found within the [Tisch Policies and Procedures Handbook](#).

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE TOOLS

The journal and reading responses are materials that should be written fully originally with your words. They are designed to be closely related to your experiences and ideas, so the use of AI tools is not encouraged for these assignments. You will not be graded on the quality of your writing but on the depth of your ideas.

There will be other portions of the course and exhibit production where you may or even be encouraged to use AI tools. However, if you use an AI system for any aspect of your work, including getting ideas, helping clarify ideas, machine translation, writing, cleaning up language, analysis, etc., in a way that hasn't been instructed in the assignment, you must:

- Clearly indicate the content of your submission that was produced with the assistance of an AI system.
- Identify the system you used.

- You should be expected to explain your usage to others and share your original experience and thoughts of your creative processes using the tools in your own words and original non-AI-assisted writing (~100 words).

Submitting/showcasing work that was created with the help of AI tools without disclosure is a violation of academic integrity in this course. We want to make sure that you are the one who is achieving the learning objectives and generating the ideas that is a public production. If you are unsure whether AI use is appropriate for a specific task, please consult the instructor and/or the TA before proceeding. We are always open to discussion on how you may want to incorporate AI into your workflow.

For readings, you may choose to use AI tools to understand the materials. However, you must not rely solely on the output of AI tools. You should budget at least 40 min to engage with the reading materials in the weeks you are assigned to the readings. The use of AI tools should not reduce your overall time spent with the reading materials, and in fact should increase your time engaged with the readings.

STATEMENT OF DIVERSITY AND ANTI-OPPRESSION

We are committed to a learning environment that is free of abuse, discrimination, harassment, and behavior that results in other students feeling unwelcome. We will not tolerate any racism, ableism, homophobia, transphobia, or ageism, and we will ensure that any behavior that results in the above is immediately addressed. But we also recognize that these structures are present in all societies, and therefore though we will strive not to enact any discriminatory behaviors towards each other, what is much more important is to have a clear process for addressing such instances. In class, we will create a code of conduct that allows for facilitating this process and provides clear protocols for ensuring that we maintain the atmosphere of trust and integrity that is necessary for a positive classroom environment. Please review [ITP/IMA's Code of Conduct](#).

DISABILITY ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

I commit to make individual arrangements to address disabilities or religious needs. Please advise me of any needs early in the semester so that I may make appropriate changes to my plans and records. (adapted from Everest Pipkin's syllabi statements)

ACCESSIBILITY

It's crucial for our community to create and uphold learning environments that empower students of all abilities. Educators and students should maintain open conversations about ways the classroom's environment could be tailored to ensure each student can

succeed and produce their best work. In the event that further accommodations are needed, students are encouraged to seek out the resources and aids available at the Moses Center for Student Accessibility.

(<https://www.nyu.edu/students/communities-and-groups/student-accessibility.html>)

WELLNESS

NYU aims to use its frameworks to support students as they achieve new levels of growth and success in their scholarship. NYU's community is nothing without the people that engage within it. We want to emphasize the importance of a holistic approach to the wellness of each individual within our community. Students are encouraged to utilize the resources and support services available to them 24 hours a day, 7 days a week through the NYU Wellness Exchange Hotline (212-443-9999).

Additional support is available over email at wellness.exchange@nyu.edu and within the NYU Wellness Exchange app.

(<https://www.nyu.edu/students/health-and-wellness/wellness-exchange.html>)

TITLE IX

Tisch School of the Arts is dedicated to providing its students with a learning environment that is rigorous, respectful, supportive and nurturing so that they can engage in the free exchange of ideas and commit themselves fully to the study of their discipline. To that end Tisch is committed to enforcing University policies prohibiting all forms of sexual misconduct as well as discrimination on the basis of sex and gender.

SPECIFIC ASSIGNMENTS:

JOURNAL ENTRIES:

This is a week-specific assignment. Refer to the specific week for specific requirement. Usually, you will submit a drawing, description, writing (3-4 sentences), render or photo of a build to Brightspace as .jpeg or PDF (with labels if necessary)

MEDIA OBJECT

PRESENTATION/DISCUSSION LEADER (5-15 MINS)

All students will sign up to present on a media object, reading, event, or phenomenon related to the concepts we are exploring—either something referenced (but not developed) that speaks to its themes. One to two students will be assigned for each class this semester, so you may want to coordinate your presentations and discussion questions with each other (or not).

- Summarize
- Perhaps an Intriguing intro / a hook (optional)
- Who wrote it/made it and when (include the historical context)
- List questions you have (and maybe your speculative answers)
- What resonated? What did you take issue with/disagree with?
- Terms that need to be defined
- Images with citation (if relevant)
- Relevant methodologies or processes (if relevant)
- Consider leading a short group activity (optional but encouraged)
- Fun theme and transitional animations (optional)

INSTALLATION PLAN AND PRESENTATION:

Before installation, you will develop a clear plan for how your work will exist in the exhibition.

Depending on your piece, this may include:

- Dimensions and spatial requirements

- Floor or wall placement
- Power requirements
- Computers, screens, projectors, speakers, sensors, or other equipment
- Network requirements
- Mounting and hardware
- Lighting conditions
- Cable management
- Interaction requirements
- Accessibility considerations
- Setup and shutdown procedures
- Installation diagrams or floor plans
- Any dependencies on neighboring works or shared infrastructure

Someone other than you should be able to look at the plan and understand what the work requires.

MAINTENANCE DOCUMENT AND PRESENTATION:

Your Maintenance document should be concrete and clear. You should consider including **photos or diagrams wherever words aren't enough**. Ideally, it is 1–2 pages, designed as an operational document that someone can actually pull up while standing in front of a broken artwork. Consider the following when you make your Maintenance Documentation:

1. **Work Information** — title, artist, contact information, brief description of how the work should normally look/behave.
2. **Daily Startup** — how to turn the piece on, launch software, connect devices/network, fill or replenish materials, set volume/brightness, etc.
3. **Daily Shutdown** — does your art need to be turned down everyday; what should be turned off, closed, unplugged, charged, covered, stored, or reset.
4. **Regular Maintenance** — what else needs attention during the exhibition and how often any maintenance should happen
5. **How to Know It Is Working** — a very simple description of expected behavior. For example: "Screen should display X; when a visitor approaches, Y should happen within 5 seconds."
6. **Troubleshooting** — likely failures and what to do:
No image → check projector power → HDMI → computer
Program frozen → restart application

Sensor not responding → reset microcontroller

And importantly: **when should someone stop troubleshooting and contact you?**

7. **Equipment & Supplies** – everything belonging to the work, including adapters, chargers, computers, cables, replacement materials, tools, passwords/access information *where appropriate and securely handled*, and where supplies are stored.
8. **Physical / Safety Considerations** – anything that should not be touched, moved, blocked, covered, exposed to water, left unattended, etc.; plus any visitor-facing concerns.
9. **Resetting the Work** – especially important for interactive work: after someone experiences it, does anything need to be physically or digitally returned to its starting state?
10. **Emergency / Failure State** – if the work cannot be fixed, what should exhibition staff do? Turn it off? Put up a temporary notice? Remove a component? Contact the artist immediately?

POST INSTALL REFLECTION:

- Did you get all the documentation you needed? What else might you want to collect?
- If you could only show one image that captures the essence of this project, which would it be?
- What have you learned? Anything you would change if you installed this work in the future? What worked the best?
- What were the conversations you had about your project that were helpful? What questions do you still have?
- Proof of documentation folder link (what we created in class)

FINAL PRESENTATION:

- Make an 5 minute presentation that addresses the following questions:
 - What is it and why did you make it?
 - How is your project in conversation with the open call prompt
 - What are your references? Pull quotes from any of the readings that spoke to you and relate to your project (bibliography and pages numbers). Show other artists and projects you are in conversation with
 - Analyze your project within the context/framework of one of the readings we did
 - For example:
 - “_____ reading is saying _____ and my project also says _____ (OR) is rejecting _____ in _____ way (OR) is in conversation with _____ in _____ way”
 - Show examples of other projects from class or out of class that inspired you
 - How is it made?
 - Materials? Process? Machines used? Failures? Successes?
 - What are your next steps?
 - Artist Bio
 - Please send me your walkup song in advance
 - The format of your presentation can be a portfolio, a slideshow, a website, a well curated instagram account, etc. (however you would like to present yourself as an artist)

Tentative Schedule

Everything is subject to change!!

Week	Theme	Guiding Question	Media Object Theme	In-class activity	Due on this day

1 9/14	What is Curating?	What does a curator do? What are the traditions in exhibition making?		Go over syllabus, assignments, and responsibility Sign up for Media object Journal Entry Sharing Concept workshop	Journal Entry
2 9/21	Exhibition Concepts & Metaconcepts	How do exhibitions produce meaning through relationships rather than simply topics?	Bring something that demonstrates a compelling conceptual framework or unexpected way of organizing ideas.	Media Object Presentation Share your idea Collaboratively develop open call description Naming activity	Reading notations <i>Start ideating for your piece</i>
3 9/28	Curating Collaborations	How do curators work with artists, designers, technicians, institutions, and communities to realize exhibitions?	Bring something that could not exist without meaningful collaboration between multiple people or disciplines.	Media Object Presentation Pending	Reading notations <i>Start working on your piece</i>

4 10/5	Experience Building & Alternative Curating	What happens when the exhibition itself becomes an experience rather than a container for objects?	Bring something where experience is more important than the object/exhibition on itself.	Media Object Presentation Experience workshop	Reading notations Work on your piece
5 10/14	Care and Maintenance	Care and maintenance of things in exhibitions Show piece/work-in-progress	Bring something that is well maintained. Show how they maintain it.	Media Object Guest Speaker: Leia Chang (Pending confirmation)	Reading notations
6 10/19	Exhibition Design: Space, Sequence, and Situation	How do architecture, layout, lighting, graphics, and movement shape interpretation?	Bring something that uses space, sequence, or environment to shape meaning. Share what impresses you about their design of the exhibition space.	Media Object Presentation Maintenance Plan sharing Guest Speaker: Ian/Phil Submit to our open call Google Form	No readings this week Maintenance Plan for your piece
7	Interpretation & Mediation	How do wall texts, catalogs, websites,	Bring something that changes	Media Object	No readings this week

10/26		labels, guides, and AI shape how audiences understand work?	how another work, idea, or experience is understood.	Guest Speaker: Mingna Label making workshop	Installation plan for your piece
8 11/2	Programming & Public Engagement	How can talks, workshops, performances, screenings, and other events extend an exhibition?	Bring something that extends beyond a static exhibition through participation, events, or public engagement.	Media Object Share Installation plan and Maintenance Plan Finalize equipment list	No readings this week Sprint on piece making
9 11/9	Planning			Piece presentation Guest Critic: pending	No readings this week Piece presentation 12 min/person
10 11/16	Install Day	Meet at Clive Davis		INSTALL!!!! Class meets in Clive Davis	No readings due this day Make adjustments
11 11/23	Documentation	Ways of documentation		Short Lecture Post-Install Reflection Show-n-Tell	Short reading Post-Install Reflection 5 min/person

12 11/30	The Politics of Curating	Who gets shown, who is excluded, and how do exhibitions produce power and representation ?	Bring something that reveals, questions, or redistributes power.	Media Object <i>Pending</i>	Reading notations
13 12/7	Why Exhibit?	What do exhibitions do for artists, audiences, research, and society that other media cannot?	Bring something that demonstrates why public exhibition matters.	Media Object Lecture	Reading notations
14 12/14	Reflection and career development			Final Presentation Discussion	No readings due this day Update artist website/bio Submit to an open call